

Comparing and Contrasting Patterns of Written Texts across Disciplines

Learner's Module in
Reading and Writing Skills 11

Quarter 3 ■ Week 1



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PREFACE

This module is a project of the Department of Education- CAR through the Curriculum Implementation Division (CID) which is in response to the implementation of the K to 12 Curriculum.

This learning material is a property of the DepEd-CAR. It aims to foster in learners a deeper understanding of written text and how they convey meaning.

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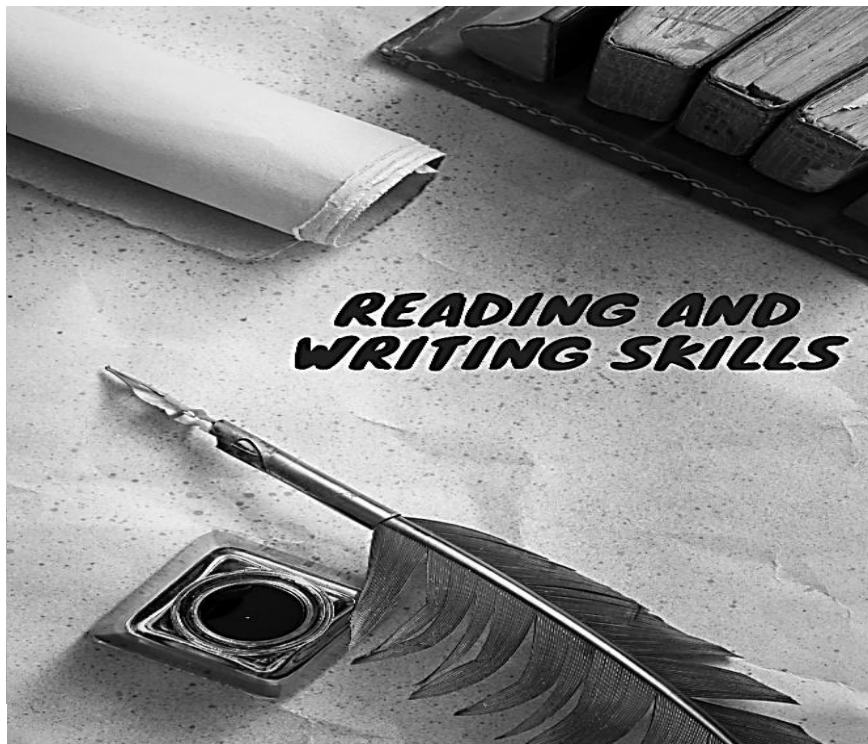
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What I Need to Know

Welcome to our lesson on **Comparing and Contrasting Patterns of Written Texts across Disciplines!**

This module is intended to help students understand the distinct differences of reading texts in various disciplines in terms of style, content, and format.

HOW TO USE THIS MODULE

To make the most out of the lesson in this module, you need to do the following:

1. Scan the list of *Learning Objectives* to get an idea of the knowledge and skills you are expected to gain and develop as you study the module. These outcomes are based on the content standards, performance standards, and learning competencies of the K to 12 Curriculum- English 11.
2. Take the *What I Know*. Your score will determine your knowledge of the lessons in the module.
3. The lesson aims to develop the learning objectives set for the module. It starts with an activity that will help you understand the lesson and meet the required competencies.
4. Take your time in reading this module. Write down points for clarification. You may discuss these points with your teacher.
5. Perform all activities. The activities and assessments are designed to enhance your understanding of written texts. The activities will also give you an idea how well you understand the lessons. Review the lessons if necessary, until you have achieved a satisfactory level of understanding.
6. At the end of the module, take the *Post-Assessment* to evaluate your overall understanding about the lessons.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of the module, you should be able to:

- 1) examine aspects of a text to determine intended meaning.
- 2) explain how authors use text to convey meaning, and
- 3) compare and contrast discipline-specific features within and different texts.

What I Know

Alternate Response: Read the following statements. Then, write **TRUE** if the statement is correct, **FALSE** if otherwise. Write your answer in your answer sheet.

1. Critical reading is a deeper and more complex engagement with a text.
2. Different authors adopt the same writing styles and conventions.
3. The term discipline as used in discourse and rhetoric means subject area or field of study.
4. Each discipline has its own specific requirements in terms of style, content, and format.
5. Your goal as a reader will change depending upon what you are reading.
6. When you speak with someone, you do not only listen to what is said, but you also listen how it is said.
7. Different disciplines will have different tones depending on the material and audience.
8. Becoming familiar with the differences on how texts are organized and structured will help you find the essential information you need.
9. All disciplines have similar jargon and language particulars.
10. Each discipline has traits that are specific to that field.
11. The main purpose of a written text in business is to entertain.
12. Tone is the expression of a writer's attitude toward subject, audience, and self.
13. Organization consists of the specific traits within a particular discipline or the conventions of a discipline's key genres.
14. Reading texts related to history would deal with what happened and explains why it happened.
15. Writing in the humanities usually seeks to analyze, interpret, argue, and/or explain thoughts, reactions, ideas, and emotions.

What's In

Understanding Reading and Writing across Disciplines

Critical reading goes beyond understanding new terminologies and identifying key ideas and minor details that are presented in reading texts. Critical readers recognize that different authors adopt a variety of style elements in writing depending on his or her purpose, audience, and genre. As a reader you need to be aware that each discipline or field of study has its own specific requirements in terms of style, content, and format.

The structure, grammar, and vocabulary of written texts vary depending on why we are writing, who we are writing for, and what we are writing about. We refer to these

predictable patterns in written language as genres. Becoming a writer and reader involves understanding the patterns and being able to use them flexibly.

Analyzing a piece of writing involves understanding the said specific requirements or the way a text is written. In this lesson, you will go through the patterns of written texts that will help you to interpret the meaning of the piece, which is ultimately the entire point of doing a close evaluation or critical reading of a piece of writing.

What's New

Activity: *Guess what!*

Would you be able to match the following concepts to their meanings on the right? Write the letter of your answer on your answer sheet.

1. Writer's purpose	A. This is the expression of a writer's attitude toward subject, audience, and self. Is primarily conveyed in writing thru diction, point of view, syntax, and level of formality.
2. Writing tone and style	B. This involves the effects of words as an important element for understanding the meaning of a text.
3. Specific language	C. This pertains to one's intention and purpose in reading.
4. Organization	D. This consists of the specific traits within a particular discipline or the conventions of a discipline's key genres.
5. Reader's goal	E. This refers to a person's reason for writing, such as to inform, entertain, explain, or persuade.
6. Discipline-specific features	F. It concerns how ideas are presented. Typically, it refers to the larger parts of a piece of writing, although it also refers to how paragraphs and sentences are written. The flow of a piece of writing affects how readers interpret ideas.

The above phrases you just worked on are the elements or aspects you need to consider in approaching a piece of writing. You need to ask yourself; *how do all of these elements create meaning? What does the passage mean and how does it contribute to the meaning of the piece of writing?*

Again, it is important to remember that each discipline is a distinct discourse community with specific vocabularies, styles, and modes of communication. **Getting familiar with the conventions of a discipline's key genres is essential in understanding a written text.**

What Is It

By surveying the landscape of various academic disciplines, you can develop further your writing, reading, and thinking. Let's study the formats/patterns of texts in selected disciplines in the text map below.

	Discipline (subject area or field of study)		
	Science	History	Pop Culture
Writer's purpose	Makes claims based on facts. Acknowledges limitations. Puts focus on research. Use concrete evidence and examples	Uses the facts of history to make a logical argument that X, Y, and Z happened as well as why they happened. Uses logic and intuition to make sense of the facts. Engages in a larger discussion with other historians. Tells what happened. Explains why it happened	Explains, outlines, and/or analyzes current trends in music, fashion, film, literature, etc. Main purpose is to entertain. Leans to light, current, and subjective topics
Writing tone and style	Writing tends to be dense, stiff, and formal. Objective tone; straightforward and informative Historically has favored the passive voice; however, active voice is now being used. Avoids first- and second-person pronouns, i.e. "I" and "you"	Avoids first- and second-person pronouns, i.e. "I" and "you" More subjective than scientific writing; however, opinions/interpretations need to be backed by evidence. Can use an informative, persuasive, or entertaining tone depending on the writer, reader, and topic	Writing tends to be less formal and friendlier. Uses first- and second-person pronouns, i.e. "I" and "you." More subjective than history and scientific writing Addresses the reader. Must be attention-grabbing because there are many options (think about the magazines at the grocery store checkout line) and topics change quickly

Reader's goal	Identify how the writer reached his/her conclusion. Understand the methodology. Understand whether it is significant/reputable. Look for the proof. Understand when it was written so you can determine if it is still significant.	Understand the argument that the author is trying to make. Separate the facts from the author's interpretation. Find any flaws in the author's reasoning. Infer and understand the logic between relationships. Remember that history is not static and be open to new interpretations of long-known facts. Understand the author's potential biases.	Understand when the pop culture piece was written as the period will influence your interpretation. This is true with many types of writing, but pop culture writing, like pop music, is especially of its own time.
Specific language	Likely to have words that might not be in the dictionary because science vocabulary evolves quickly. Language is precise. Writers choose to use the most specific word rather than use a word that may be more familiar. Many words, including the new words, are derived from Greek and Latin; when you see an unfamiliar word, you may be able to piece it together if you know Greek and Latin word parts.	Older primary sources contain archaic language that will make understanding, more difficult. Uses words or expressions that may have only been used in a particular period. Its use may have died out or changed in meaning. Current sources that discuss past events will focus on the language of causes and consequences of certain events.	Words are specific to both the time and the place of the piece. Language needs to be interpreted considering when it was written. Recent events and trends are quickly included in the vernacular.

Organization	Taxonomists use classification.	Historians organize by categories of action and not chronological order; that is all events relating to technology may be grouped together, while education-related events are grouped separately. Within each category of action, events are arranged chronologically; uses narrative. Overall, historians make an argument and support it with evidence.	Uses a variety of organizational strategies including comparison and narration. Depends heavily on hooks and story-like qualities that create an interesting and easy flow.
Discipline-specific features	Figures, tables, graphs, and charts. Often requires basic to advanced levels of mathematical literacy to understand.	Will reference primary sources, that is, texts written at the time you are studying. For example, if you are studying about the Civil War, a primary text could include a letter from President Lincoln from a Union soldier.	Pop culture moves progressively from local to national to international levels.

Key Points

Writing in the **humanities** usually seeks to analyze, interpret, argue, and/or explain thoughts, reactions, ideas, and emotions. The “humanities,” as a discipline, includes not only literature, but also philosophy, economics, ethics, performing arts, fine arts, history, and aspects of anthropology, cultural studies, foreign languages, and linguistics.

Writing in **business** often means explaining a situation, event, or change to compel the reader toward a very specific action. Business has a special vocabulary (jargon), so first of all you have to learn its jargon, like remit, obligate, loan, collateral, interest, stocks, etc. Some compound nouns are standard expressions in business, like tax collection system, company car, price list, bulk buying, etc.

You must also learn some of the conventions, or established practices, of business writing. For example, business uses a lot of form letters, so you have to be familiar with the standard forms (meaning the parts) of a business letter, a memo, minutes of a meeting, a proposal, etc. Some standard parts of business communication are date, inside address, the salutation, the body or main purpose of the communication, the complimentary close, etc.

It is important to remember that business requires cordiality to sustain it, to keep the customer. Hence, even if the content of a communication is negative—like a complaint or a collection—the communication must be polite. There is careful use of modal expressions and adverbs. Polite expressions such as the following are part of the ritual of politeness in business: (Cortes de los Rios, 2010).

In the field of **natural science** (physics, chemistry, and biology, astronomy, geology, marine science, mathematics, ecology, computer science, etc.), technical terms, symbols (ph, NaCl, and CO₂) and abbreviations are common. Similar to other disciplines, common words like power, pressure, force, work, and impulse have a technical meaning. To help yourself understand many of the technical terms, you must know some prefixes (uni, semi, and multi), root words (bio, geo, vis, and derma), and suffixes. Diagrams and drawings are also characteristic of science texts.

The typical sentences in science texts are dense; that is, they are information heavy. An example is this: *Each nucleus is packed with information coded in the form of a chemical called Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA) and organized into groups called genes which are arranged on thread-like structures, the chromosomes.* The lengthy and dense sentences found in science texts suggest slow reading for comprehension and retention of facts.

Other disciplines have their own writing conventions that we need to familiarize ourselves with.

What's More

Activity: Text Mapping

You are now aware that academic writing conventions vary substantially according to discipline—that is, whether one is working in the humanities, the social or natural sciences, or business.

Exercise 1: Describe the **specific features** of written texts in the identified disciplines.

Discipline-specific organizational features	Discipline (subject area or field of study)		
	Math	Literature	Business

Exercise 2: Examine the following passages, then answer the questions that follow.

This study aims to investigate the current situation with regards to special guardianship, introduced in the early years of the 21st century following the Adoption and Children Act in 2002. It was designed to provide an option to allow a more secure and permanent option where formal adoption was not appropriate, for example where children needed to retain a close connection with their natural family (Miller 2006, p. 8). Special Guardianship Orders were implemented in two phases, with the first taking place in late 2003 and the second in 2005, with associated Regulations set in place (Miller and Bentovim 2006, p. 12). It is now several years since the Special Guardianship option has been available, and it seems a good idea to look at how useful it has been, and whether there are problems with its implementation.

1. What is given emphasis in the written text?
2. What could be the purpose of the author in writing the text?
3. Explain how the author's purpose shapes the content and delivery.
4. Which discipline would you categorize the excerpt based on its text?

Many thermometers are thin glass tubes filled with a liquid. Mercury and alcohol are often used in thermometers because they remain in liquid form over a large temperature range. Thermometers can measure temperature because of a property called thermal expansion. Thermal expansion is the increase in volume of a substance because of an increase in temperature. As a substance's temperature increases, its particles move faster and spread out. So, there is more space between them, and the substance expands. Mercury and alcohol expand by constant amounts for a given change in temperature.

1. What is the focus of the written text?
2. What discipline would you classify the above text?

Music. It is the sound of every day. It is the cadence of typing on a keyboard, or the rhyming of lyrics. In the Fine and Performing Arts Academy, I hope to be part of the experience, the dance, the performing, and the art. I always see opportunity in the Performing Arts; whether learning a new instrument, learning different dances, joining a choir, or auditioning for a musical. I want to try something new. I want to learn the technical aspects of video and audio recording and learning how to use professional equipment. However, my heart goes deeply for the soul of music.

1. What is the tone of the piece? (cheerful? sarcastic? pessimistic? melancholic? aggressive? hopeful? etc.)
2. How is the text organized? Is it through description (spatial)? is it through narration (chronological)? Is it through analysis (logical)?

What I Have Learned

Activity: *Footprints!*

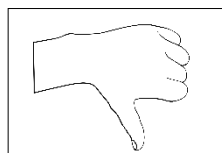
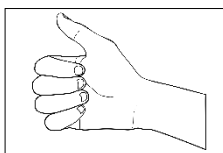
Write what new knowledge or understanding you are “walking away” from the lesson with. Craft a one-paragraph answer to this. (20 points)

Paragraph Assessment Rubric

Point Value	5 points	4 points	3 points	2 points
Topic Sentence	Interesting, original topic sentence, reflecting thought and insight; focused on one interesting main idea.	Clearly stated topic sentence presents one main idea.	Acceptable topic sentence presents one idea.	Missing, invalid, or inappropriate topic sentence; main idea is missing.
Supporting Details	Interesting, concrete, and descriptive examples and details with explanations that relate to the topic.	Examples and details relate to the topic and some explanation is included.	Sufficient number of examples and details that relate to the topic.	Insufficient, vague, or undeveloped examples.
Organization and Transitions	Thoughtful, logical progression of supporting examples; Mature transitions between ideas.	Details are arranged in a logical progression; appropriate transitions.	Acceptable arrangement of examples; transitions may be weak.	No discernible pattern of organization; Unrelated details; no transitions.
Mechanics and Style	Appropriate tone, distinctive voice; pleasing variety in sentence structure; Vivid diction, precise word choices. No grammatical errors.	Appropriate tone; Clear sentences with varied structures; Effective diction. Some errors, but nonmajor, in usage, spelling, or punctuation. (1-2)	Acceptable tone; some variety in sentence structures; Adequate diction and word choices. A few errors in usage, spelling, or punctuation (3-4)	Inconsistent or inappropriate tone; Awkward, unclear, or incomplete sentences; Bland diction, poor word choice. Distracting errors in usage, spelling, or punctuation

What I Can Do

Activity: *Thumbs Up/Thumbs Down!*



React to the given statement by picking from the two symbols: **thumbs up** and **thumbs down**. Give a two to three-sentence explanation of your decision.

It is important that readers understand the different text or language structures (patterns of written texts) to able to understand what is read.

Post- Assessment

Alternate Response: Read each of the following statements. Then, write **TRUE** if the statement is correct, **FALSE** if otherwise. Write your answer in your answer sheet.

1. Each discipline has its own specific requirements in terms of style, content, and format.
2. Critical reading gets at "deep structure" (if there is such a thing apart from the superficial text!), that is, logical consistency, tone, organization, and a number of other very important sounding terms.
3. Different authors adopt similar writing styles and conventions.
4. Your goal as a reader will not change depending upon what you are reading.
5. The term discipline as used in discourse and rhetoric means orderly or prescribed conduct or pattern of behavior.
6. Writing in the humanities focuses on informing the reader of new discoveries and assisting readers in discovering truth through facts and solid data provided in detail.
7. Patterns of content and language shape the portrayal of the topic.
8. Becoming familiar with the differences on how texts are organized and structured will help you find the essential information you need.
9. Each discipline has its own jargon and language particulars.
10. Different disciplines will have different tones depending on the material and audience.
11. Tone is the expression of a writer's attitude toward subject, audience, and self.
12. Organization consists of the specific traits within a particular discipline or the conventions of a discipline's key genres.
13. Reading texts related to history would deal with what happened and explains why it happened.
14. Writing in the humanities usually seeks to analyze, interpret, argue, and/or explain thoughts, reactions, ideas, and emotions.
15. The main purpose of a written text in business is to entertain.

Additional Activity

Gather **one** example of a text and try to examine how it is written. Focus on the dominant text patterns. Take note of the language cues. Do any appropriate text mapping strategy to show the overall organization and content of the material, or you may use the template below to present your analysis.

Title of text	
Discipline (Subject Area)	
Writer's purpose	
Writing tone and style	
Specific Language	
Organization	
Reader's Goal	
Discipline- specific features	

ANSWER KEY

What's More Exercise 1 Discipline (subject area or field of study)		Discipline-specific organizational features		Exercise 2 Text A - social science Text B - natural science Text C - humanities Answers may vary for the rest of the questions	
		Math	Notations, numbers, and formulas are typical of math texts.		
	Literature	Writing is artistic. Engages the reader by using creative language and imagery; there is dominant use of connotative language and figures of speech to describe and convey content.			
	Business	Observes a specialized organization in documents such as résumés, memos, and product descriptions.			

Post-assessment (Posttest)											
1. T	2. T	3. F	4. F	5. F	6. F	7. T	8. T	9. T	10. T	11. T	12. F
13. T	14. T	15. F									

What's New Writer's purpose - a person's reason for writing, such as to inform, entertain, explain, or persuade. Writing tone and style-effects of words as an underlying element for understanding the text meaning Specific language-primarily conveyed in writing thru diction, point of view, syntax, and level of formality Organization-how ideas are presented Reader's goal-one's intention and purpose in reading Discipline-specific feature-specific traits within a particular discipline
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What I Have Learned Answers may vary	What I Can Do Answers may vary
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What I Know (Pre-assessment) 1. T 2. F 3. T 4. T 5. T 6. T 7. T 8. T 9. F 10. T 11. F 12. T 13. F 14. T 15. T

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